process was in serious doubt. Ultimately, the NLD decided to continue to participate and would run candidates for 451 of the 492 assembly seats.

Surprisingly, the SLORC went to great lengths to ensure the electoral process was credible. Ballots would be secret and standards were set to guarantee accuracy. Provisions for absentee ballots were set and procedural mechanics were in place to establish transparency. Martial law was revoked in the period prior to Election Day. Finally, the military kept a low profile while the election took place.

The results were a shock to SLORC. The NLD won nearly 60 percent of the vote and 392 of 485 constituencies contested. The pro-government National Unity Party garnered 21 percent and only 10 seats. The voter turnout was the largest for any election in the history of Burma with 72.6 percent turning out to participate. It was painfully obvious that SLORC's plan had gone terribly wrong. Some evidence points to the fact that members of the tatmadaw and their families may have indeed supported the NLD candidates. The regime's paranoia increased.

The NLD thanked the regime for carrying out a free and fair electoral process. However, after several weeks, apprehension set in as SLORC did not take any steps to seat the new Pyithu Hluttaw. The regime was not sure what action to take. The party line was that the tatmadaw would continue to fulfill its promise to maintain law and order and work toward the goal of providing the basic necessities for the citizens of Burma. Until these goals were met, a transition could not take place. Furthermore, the junta focused on the need to put forth a new constitution prior to any transition taking place. This seemed not only illogical, but also an obvious stall tactic.

SLORC formalized its noncompliance with Declaration 1/90 issued on July 27, which stated the following: transfer of power could not take place until a new constitution was finalized; representatives were elected to draft a constitution; and until a new constitution was in place, SLORC would maintain total authority for governing Burma. The document made it clear that all legislative, executive, and judicial powers rested with SLORC.

The response from the NLD came in the form of the Gandhi Hall Declaration issued several days after the SLORC announcement. The Gandhi Hall Declaration called for the convening of the Pyithu Hluttaw as soon as possible, with a September deadline set. This was the expectation of